



Gorilla Glass 3

"Corning," of Gorilla Glass fame, announced and showcased "Gorilla Glass 3" at CES 2013



Facebook messenger news

According to reports, Facebook is working on adding voice messaging and VoIP feature in its Messenger app for smartphones <http://dgit.in/132XYRi>

Calling Qualcomm

We talk about the future of LTE, their latest chips and opportunities in India

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Given that Qualcomm is at the centre of the implementation of LTE-TDD in India, what are the biggest challenges to get LTE off the ground in India?

In India, Bharti Airtel launched their commercial LTE-TDD network with multimode dongles based on Qualcomm Technologies' MDM9x00 in Kolkata, Bangalore and Pune. India's mobile broadband needs can only be met when 3G HSPA/EV-DO & LTE work in harmony to provide the best solution for coverage and capacity. 3G HSPA/EV-DO must be the underlay that provides wide-scale coverage while LTE will be deployed in dense areas for additional capacity. While LTE is expected to become more prevalent in the long term, most Indian operators are focused on maximizing the value and performance of their 3G HSPA/EV-DO services to ensure consumers have a fantastic mobile broadband experience.

Qualcomm has been very successful in the SoC space, thanks to the S4 series of processors. Can you share some details on the latest MSM8226 and MSM8626 chips and what devices they will be targeting? These Qualcomm Snapdragon S4 processors with quad-core CPUs will bring premium multimedia and connectivity features to high-volume 3G handsets. Featuring the powerful Adreno 305 GPU, 1080p capture and playback, and up to a 13 megapixel camera, the MSM8226 and MSM8626 processors are optimized to deliver visually stunning graphics and exceptionally long battery life to high-volume smartphones. Building on Qualcomm Technologies' previous quad-core offering, both the MSM8226 and MSM8626 processors are fabricated using the 28nm technology node and will continue to support multi-SIM capabilities with Dual SIM, Dual Standby and Dual SIM, Dual Active. In addition to a quad-core CPU, these chipsets incorporate



Dr. Avneesh Agrawal, Senior Vice President, Qualcomm Technologies and President, Qualcomm India and South Asia

the new WTR2605 multi-mode radio transceiver, and offer 40 percent power savings and 60 percent smaller footprint compared to previous generations.

The Snapdragon S4 Pro vs the Exynos 5250, the latest dual-core SoC from Samsung, your thoughts?

In fact, our highly integrated, multicore processors consistently beat the competition in third-party benchmark reviews and user experience testing. For example, our Snapdragon S4 8960 processor, featuring a dual-core Krait CPU, outperforms the competitors' quad-core solutions in the majority of third-party benchmark reviews.

Can you share details on the Qualcomm Reference Design (QRD) program?

QRD brings together the value of the mobile industry leader with specific products, features and programs for emerging markets. Device manufacturers should not have to trade off quality and innovation for price. The QRD program offers Qualcomm's leading technical innovation, differentiated hardware and software, easy

customisation options that save engineering costs and speed time to market, access to an ecosystem of hardware and software providers, and testing and acceptance readiness for regional and leading operator requirements. In India, Qualcomm is working with all the leading Indian brands.

How bullish is Qualcomm on the low-end smartphone and tablet market?

We are quite bullish on the affordable 3G smartphone and tablet opportunity in India which has low penetration of PCs and laptops. Qualcomm has played a key role in catalysing India's wireless revolution by making mobile communication affordable and accessible. We believe many Indians will get their first experience of mobile Internet and computing on a 3G smartphone, since smartphone affordability is a reality today. Qualcomm Snapdragon processors are leading this trend by enabling affordable 3G smartphones at sub ₹5,000 price point and 3G tablets below ₹10,000.

Qualcomm has invested heavily in Sharp which is into making displays. Is this a future business division for Qualcomm for making tablets or ebook readers?

Qualcomm recently announced the expansion of our display technology development between Qualcomm's wholly-owned subsidiary Pixtronix, Inc. and Sharp Corporation. The goal is to develop and commercialize high-quality color, low-power MEMS displays incorporating IGZO-based display (Indium Gallium Zinc Oxide) technology and utilizing existing LCD manufacturing infrastructure. In addition, Qualcomm is making an equity investment in Sharp Corporation to become a minority shareholder in Sharp. Expanding our existing relationship with Sharp to jointly commercialize new MEMS display technologies will help both companies realize their shared goal of driving high-performance, lower power displays for a variety of devices, including smartphones and tablets. **d**